thames view
YOUR COMMUNITY MAGAZINE
ISSUE 6
JULY 05

IT'S A GREEN LIGHT FOR TAVY BRIDGE

After many months of hard work behind the scenes, Gallions Housing Association and Wates Construction have now got outline planning permission for the regeneration of Tavy Bridge. This is great news for everyone who has been involved so far, including all those residents who have taken time to give us their input and ideas. It means that the way is now clear for work to begin on the 'new look' Tavy Bridge and for those residents who have lived there since the early days, it is a time of great change as we watch a whole new neighbourhood take shape.

While it is hard to imagine the impact Tavy's regeneration will have on the whole of Thamesmead, one thing is clear, it will breathe more life into the area with new homes and leisure facilities. Broadway Malyan, the architects responsible for the new look Tavy Bridge are able to more than double the amount of homes in the area, giving more people the opportunity to enjoy the smart new homes available, which will help to build on a really positive and committed community.



COMMUNITY NEWS
Out and about in Thamesmead

SUMMER FESTIVAL
Four page pull out festival programme

SAFETY FIRST
Neighbourhood Wardens at work

GALLIONS HOUSING ASSOCIATION

Continued

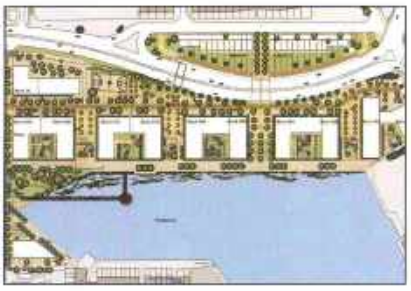


While the regeneration plans may have been in the pipeline for some time, the proposals have received a lot of support along the way. In particular the project received an enormous boost when it was awarded a massive £10 million grant from the Office of the Deputy Prime Minister. Such support from the ODPM will help underpin not just the transformation of Tavy Bridge, but of Thamesmead as a whole. Tony Cotter, Gallions' Chief Executive says:



"I am delighted that we have received permission to begin one of the most exciting regeneration schemes in the Thames Gateway. This is another strategic investment by Gallions and its partners to improve the quality of life for the Tavy Bridge community. Our unique and well established neighbourhood management of the entire public realm will help to ensure that the quality of life improvements will be maintained into the future. It's not just about building a new community it's also about providing a complete neighbourhood management service to maintain a safe, secure and clean environment".

A bright future



Bexley Council gave the go-ahead after key stakeholders such as the Greater London Authority, the environment agency and the Tavy Bridge residents reached agreement over a number of outstanding issues. With 5 detailed permissions already received for phase one, developers are all set to refurbish Tavy Bridge's



famous tower blocks. Thamesmead has often been on the receiving end of negative press and Gallions is confident that the multi- million pound regeneration of Tavy Bridge will go a long way in changing people's perception of an area that has much to offer.

A thriving community

Trust Thamesmead, one of the area's leading charities, has welcomed the Tavy Bridge redevelopment and believes it will be a big help in overcoming some of the social problems the estate has suffered. Chief executive Mick Hayes is confident that Tavy Bridge will once again become a vibrant neighbourhood, for young and old alike.

"The regeneration will provide more private and shared-ownership homes, creating a more diverse community and bringing in people with more spending power."

Tavy Bridge's award-winning design has always attracted attention over the years. Today, with the end of an era in sight, its residents can now look forward to the highest standards of 21st century living.

The facts and figures at a glance

- demolition of 230 of Tavy Bridge's 326 flats and maisonettes
- refurbishment of 96 flats at Tilehurst Point and Trewsbury House
- building 827 new homes at Tavy Bridge and Binsey Walk
- additional 556 private homes to be sold on open market
- estimated cost £138 million, estimated completion 2013

ISSUE #6
editorial

Transforming Thamesmead

There is a good feeling around Thamesmead these days – and it's not just to do with the warm weather. Everyone is delighted that the final hurdle in progressing the regeneration of Tavy Bridge has been jumped.

Residents can now really begin to see how their homes will be transformed and, people who live outside of Thamesmead are beginning to see the whole area in a new light. We know that Thamesmead is a good place to live with a great community spirit - very soon a lot more people will be thinking the same thing.

1 **Tavy Bridge**
One step closer

4 **Community News**
Summer fun in Thamesmead

5 **Festival Special**
Your pull out and keep programme

9 **Safety Special**
A new scheme to boost safety

10 **Dates and News Review**
Keep ahead of the times

12 **Have Your Say**
Let us meet your group

Community News





Francesca and Chantelle Down with coach Anthony

Family football fun

Watch out for summer evenings full of fun when Charlton Athletic bring their famous football skills to Thamesmead. There's professional coaching, nutrition tips as well as a whole lot of sport for the kids. Francesca Down says, *"I got to learn how to play football and now I know I'm good and I could show my Dad how I play."*

Charlton Athletic, Gallions Housing Association and Areas of Opportunity - this summer's winning team. For more information please telephone 020 8320 3681.

Cricket on the Green

Gallions' Wardens are planning a month of sports and fun-filled games this August. Cricket, rounders and races will help keep the kids busy throughout the month. For three days a week Birchmere and Southmere parks will be filled with kids being bowled out, bowled over and simply stumped. Howzat!

For more information please contact Lee Gaul on 0208 320 3431.



Chinese Music Festival





The sweltering heat of a June evening didn't sap the enthusiasm of the children of Thamesmead Music School as they performed at the school's first festival of Chinese Music. The school's principal, Mrs Fang Fang Lin has worked tirelessly to get the school up and running. Her determination to deliver an exceptional level of teaching has seen even the very youngest child progress at a remarkable rate. Conducted by Mr Kent Lee, the hour-long concert opened with the choir singing 'Jasmine', the theme song of the 2008 Beijing Olympic Games. Poems and piano solos were followed by a series of violin recitals including Hot Cross Buns and Frère Jacques. The children, their parents and all the guests agreed that it was a great evening with some real talent on show. We hope it is the first of many.

Thanks to everybody who entered our Liberty X competition. All the entries were great but as always, there can only be one winner. And our lucky winner is Rachael Prime. Rachael, her big sister and two of her friends will meet the band at the Trust Thamesmead Festival on 16th July. When we told Rachael's mum Gloria the news she was thrilled."It will be such a big surprise for her."

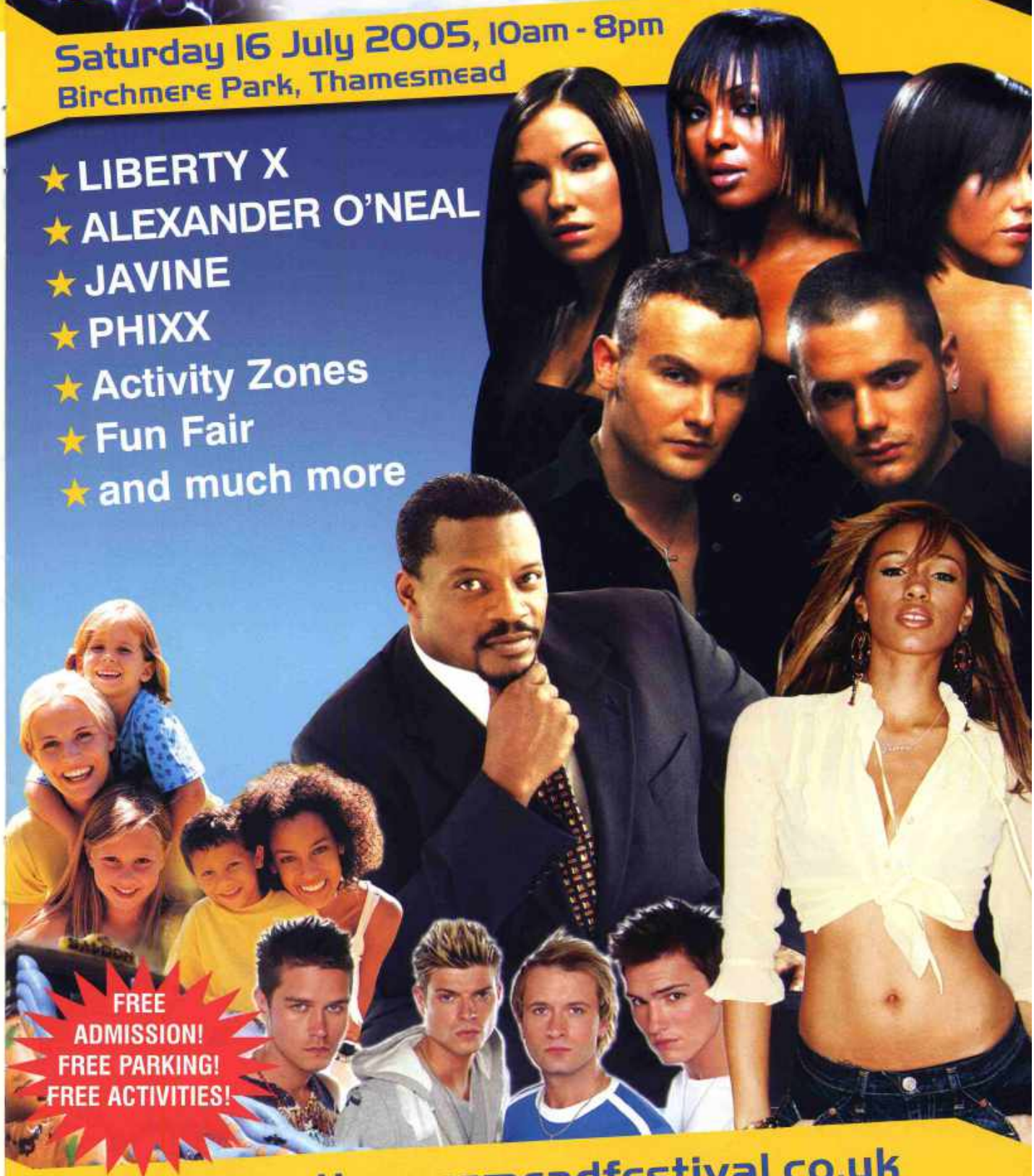
Well done Rachael and enjoy your time with Liberty X

The Thamesview Team

TRUST THAMESMEAD SUMMER FESTIVAL

Saturday 16 July 2005, 10am - 8pm
Birchmere Park, Thamesmead

- ★ LIBERTY X
- ★ ALEXANDER O'NEAL
- ★ JAVINE
- ★ PHIXX
- ★ Activity Zones
- ★ Fun Fair
- ★ and much more



FREE ADMISSION!
FREE PARKING!
FREE ACTIVITIES!

www.thamesmeadfestival.co.uk

Garden Bandstand *Sponsored by* **Team Gallions**

12:00	Usual Suspects	Classic acoustic rock
12:45	Slade Green & Pelham schools	Songs with signing
13:15	Planet Earth	Music-based youth project
13:45	Thamesmead Youth Service	Music-based project
14:15	Marshall, French and Dempsey	Jazz
15:00	Usual Suspects	Return for a second set
15:45	Lee Mitchell	Acoustic singer/songwriter
16:30	Sam Adams	Country/rock vocalist
17:15	Usual Suspects	Final set

Community Stage *Sponsored by* **Axis Europe**

12:00	Theatre Train	Performing Arts
12:30	Greenwich Sickle Cell Support Group	Singers/dancers
12:55	Black Diamond	Rap/Hip Hop artist
13:15	The Capers	Gang Show
13:45	Kamarl	Male Soloist
14:15	Abbey Wood School	Various
15:00	Sugahunnies	Singers/dancers
15:15	Thamesmead Christian Fellowship	Music rap
15:40	Hawksmoor School	Singing group
16:05	Thamesmead Youth Awareness Project	Various
17:10	Angel *(Bexley Youth Service)*	Female R&B singer
17:20	Surf 74 *(Bexley Youth Service)*	Four piece boy band
17:35	Bexley Youth Service	5 Piece
17:40	Bexley Business Academy	Tribute to the Sixties
17:50	Derry Shelem	Male soloist
18:00	Myztikal	Street Dance

Performance times may be subject to change

The Community Village

Meet local community groups who'll be at the festival promoting their activities. They'll either encourage you to get involved or to part with your money as they seek to raise funds for their activities!

The Time Tunnel *Sponsored by* **Tilfen Land**

Do not miss this amazing cinematic experience! In less than three minutes you'll be taken backwards and forwards in time to see Thamesmead and the Thames as you've never seen them before! Words can't describe what you'll see and hear. You'll just have to come along and experience it for yourselves!

Festival Fun Zone (under 5's)

Sponsored by **Gallions Housing Association**

A free entry and free activity play zone with ball ponds, bouncy castles and ever-popular face painting. During busy times a time limit will apply. No child may enter the Fun Zone without a parent or carer.

Inflatable Kingdom

Designed for 'bigger people' between 5-12 years this free activity zone has larger inflatables including Gladiator Jousting and slides. Entry will be controlled with a maximum of 40 people allowed inside at any given time. During busy times a time limit will also apply. No child may enter the Inflatable Kingdom without a parent or carer.

Forrest's Funfair

With a great selection of family and children's rides as well as Wild Thing & the Cage (4' 6" height restriction applies). All funfair rides are an incredible £1 a go and as no fun fair is complete without the Dodgems we'll have them too. At just £1.50 per car (max one/two people) you can afford to bring a friend! There'll be other attractions too including the Fun House (£1 per person, small children must be accompanied by an adult) and games stalls to suit all ages (£2 a game).

Scrap Kingdom Parade

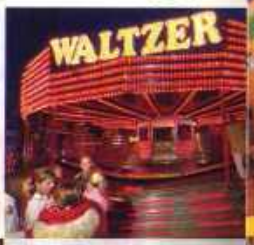
More than 250 schoolchildren from eight Thamesmead schools will take part and it'll be a feast for your eyes! Supported by Taru Brazil, an artist-led environmental education group, the parade starts at 12 noon from the 1 o'clock Club in Birchmere Park.











The Main Music Stage

Who's on and when?

13:00 The Greenwich Youth Band
13:50 Triquetra
14:20 4 Tune
15:00 ALEXANDER O'NEAL
15:30 Glitzzi Girlz
16:00 Blues Brothers
16:30 5 Boyz
16:55 The Tubes
17:30 Dualers
17:55 The Show Singers
18:25 PHIXX
18:50 JAVINE
19:20 LIBERTY X
20:00 Thank you and Goodnight

Main stage comperes:
Andrew Sayers, TGR Sound
Danny Thorpe, Trust Thamesmead



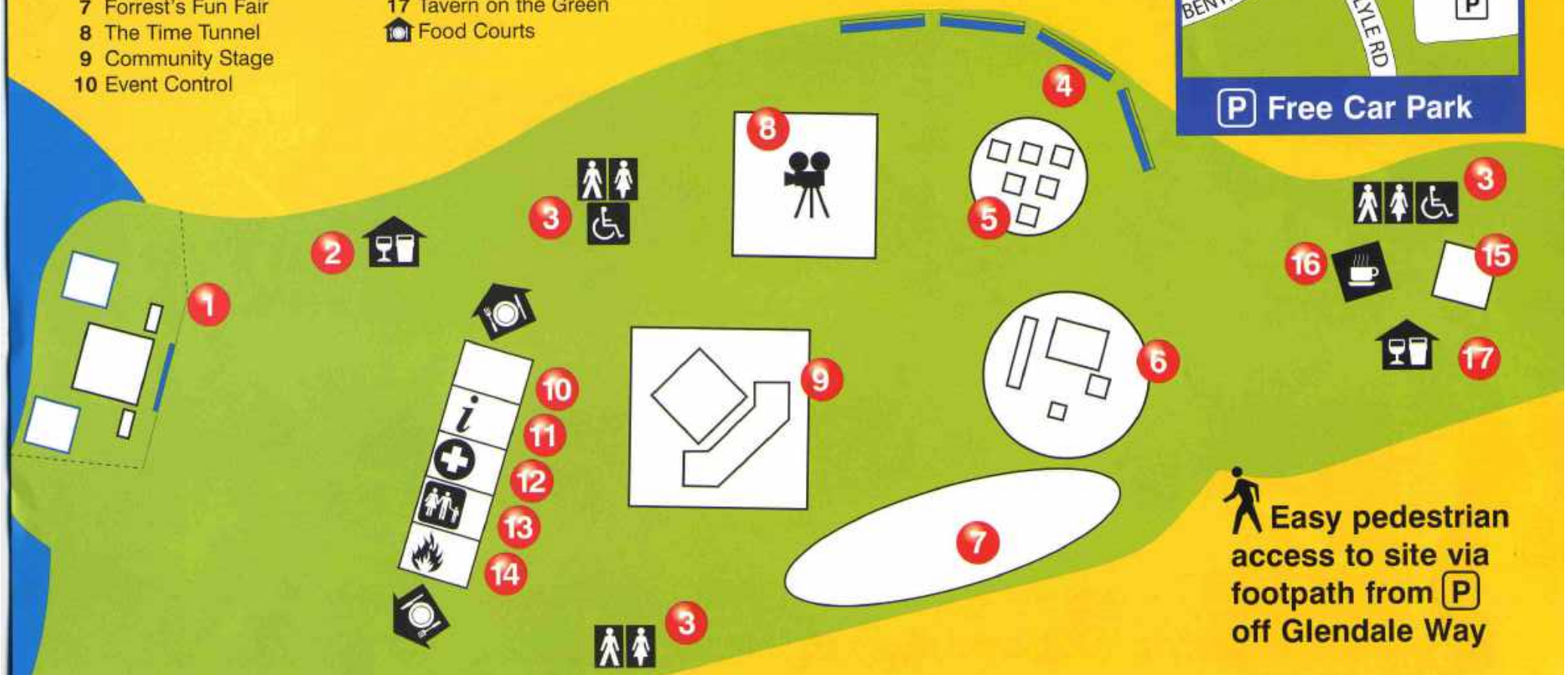


Trust Thamesmead Summer Festival Site Plan

1 Main Stage
2 Bar
3 Public Toilets
4 Community Village
5 Festival Fun Zone
6 Inflatable Kingdom
7 Forrest's Fun Fair
8 The Time Tunnel
9 Community Stage
10 Event Control
11 Information
12 First Aid
13 Lost Children
14 Fire Services
15 Garden Bandstand
16 Tea Room
17 Tavern on the Green
Food Courts

Parking in Birchmere Park for Pass Holders and Disabled Blue Badge Holders only





Easy pedestrian access to site via footpath from P off Glendale Way

The information contained in this programme was correct at the time of publication. Whilst every effort will be made to deliver the advertised programme, the festival organisers cannot be held responsible for any subsequent changes that may be necessary owing to operational or technical reasons.All activities on site are governed by procedural guidelines and certain restrictions may apply. Please see the notices located by each activity or ask a staff member/artist associated with the activity in which you are interested. Stewards will be on site throughout the day. If you have any questions or experience any problems during your visit please contact a member of staff. Alcohol and glass bottles are not permitted within the site. Barbeques are strictly prohibited. These and any glass bottles will be removed by stewards. No video cameras or recording devices will be permitted in the area during showtime.

Trust Thamesmead would like to thank all festival sponsors, the Metropolitan Police and the London Boroughs of Bexley and Greenwich for their support.

Safety is Childsplay





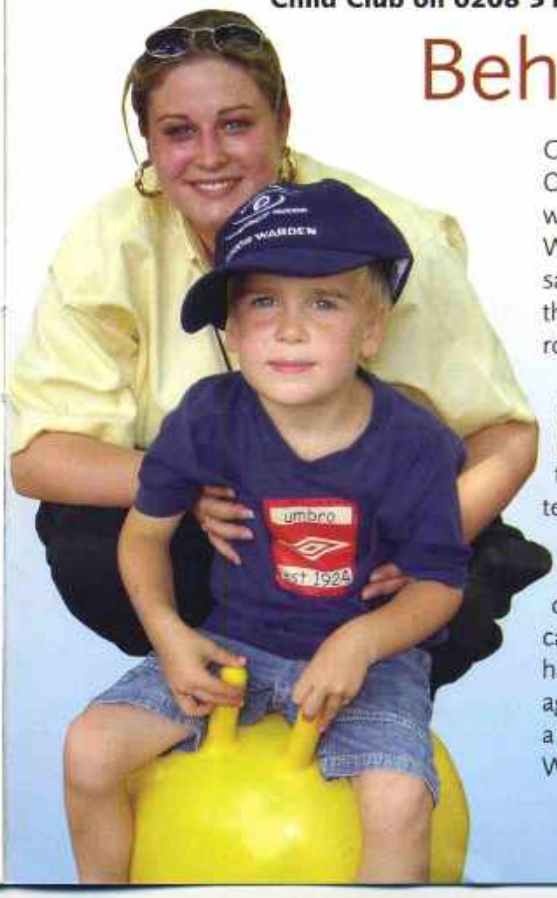
It costs quite a bit of money to kit out your house with stair gates, socket covers and smoke alarms. That's not even thinking about the buggies and car seats that are needed to transport children safely.

To help Thamesmead's parents and carers keep their young safe, Greenwich Council and Trust Thamesmead have launched a scheme where some household safety items can be bought at a reduced cost. Items include stair-gates, high chairs, buggies and travel cots. While similar schemes are running in Glyndon and Eltham, this is the first of its kind for Abbey Wood and Thamesmead.



Julie Feleppa, the Home and Road Safety Officer from Greenwich Council was at the scheme's launch at the Birchmere Carer and Child Club. Julie says: *"The launch was all about helping people access safety equipment and providing them with information about keeping their kids safe. There was information on how to fit car seats properly, a lollipop lady talked about road safety – it's advice and knowledge like this that may well help safe lives."*

Linda Delieu, Child care co-ordinator, at Trust Thamesmead has been driving this project forward for some time and was delighted to see it get off the ground. *"The scheme is open to anyone. It is a great opportunity for parents and carers alike to ensure that their home is as safe as it can be. With so many accidents happening at home it really is better to be safe than sorry."* **For more information please contact the Birchmere Carer and Child Club on 0208 311 8886.**



Behind the scenes

Gallions' Resident Involvement Officer *Wendy Mason* caught up with one of the Neighbourhood Wardens who helped organise the safety day. She takes a look at how the Wardens played an important role on the day.

Fliss Dunbar has been a neighbourhood warden for less than a year. When she and her team were asked to come up with an idea to keep parents and toddlers entertained at the safety day, it was time to get the thinking caps on. As the day was to promote health as well as safety, it was agreed that an obstacle course with a football as a prize would be ideal. With only 3 weeks to get things organised, Fliss dug in her heels and got down to work. Helped by her family, including her sister Shel who is a nursery nurse, Fliss put together a course that was both fun and safe. Shel was able to provide a number of items that could be used in the course while Nuxley Toy Shop in Welling contributed to the cost of the prizes. All who took part, parents, carers, wardens and children agree that it was great fun. Fliss said *"I am really happy with the turn out and it has been great to see everyone enjoying themselves after all the hard work."*

Happy faces all round – what more can you ask?

Trust Thamesmead would like to thank all festival sponsors, the Metropolitan Police and the London Boroughs of Bexley and Greenwich for their support.

reasons. All activities on site are governed by procedural guidelines and certain restrictions may apply. Please see the notices located by each activity or ask a staff

Dates for your diary

We want to build clear channels of communication between Gallions and our residents. Why not come along and see what's happening in your neighbourhood.

Tel: Wendy Mason 0208 320 3417

Neighbourhood Forums

Have your say on community issues and how services are delivered in your area

19th July Crossway and Manorway 7.00pm Manor Close Hall

27th July Lesnes, Parkview and Greenmead 7.00 pm Atrium

Street Briefings

Talk to your local police about local issues

7th July at 7pm Hartslock Drive outside Trewsbury House

19th August at 7pm, Fairway Drive outside football cage

Resident Information Sessions

Watch out for more deatils of our summer sessions

News Review

Post office in pole position

Thamesmead residents were delighted to learn that a new post office opens in the CTN shop at 2a Joyce Dawson Way on 7th July. The Thamesmead town centre branch replaces the existing one being scrapped in Morrisons supermarket in June. Erith and Thamesmead MP John Austin said:

"A year ago we were facing the prospect of having no post office in the town centre at all so this is excellent news." Not only will the new post office branch remain in a convenient location, it has the added bonus of a disabled access. After a year of uncertainty, post office customers can now breathe a sigh of relief.

Kicking up a stink

It may have taken nearly two years since a notice was first served but Thames Water is again taking significant steps to limit the foul smell coming from the Crossness Works.

While improvements have already been made, a court ruling in April outlined exactly what else should be done to ensure residents do not endure another summer of stink.

In his final judgement His Honour Judge Byers said: *"In my view, good sense has prevailed on both sides and they have found a way forward to solving a serious local problem."* While the summer may be long and hot, the air will at least be fresher.

Mediation drop in days

Mediation is often used in circumstances such as disputes with neighbours, family issues or problems between young people at school. The Family Service Unit (FSU) is holding two drop-in days over the summer in the FSU offices at 3 Maran Way, Thamesmead. It is an opportunity for members of the community to find out more about mediation and the services they can access. Trained mediators will also be on hand to talk to any one with a specific case. If you need help in resolving an on-going dispute why not come along to the FSU drop-in sessions.

22nd July, 10am - 2pm
10th August, 1pm-5pm

Telephone 0208 30 6570

Operating within the team

Gallions' Director of Operations Alison Breese rolled up her sleeves and took up the Team Gallions Challenge without hesitation.



All new employees are encouraged to spend a day with the Team to see first hand the demands of their job. Alison, who joined the Association in January of this year, was full of praise for Team Gallions' specialist environmental work.

A question of sport

Thamesmead is full of fanatic footballers, ambitious athletes and all round sporting stars. That's why Trust Thamesmead is keen to improve the leisure and sports facilities for Thamesmead and the surrounding area. There is a lot of potential for a great multi-sports facility in Thamesmead and we want to make sure we provide something that works for everyone. Continuum Sports and Leisure Ltd has been asked to gather information about what people want to see from a new leisure centre. If you have any thoughts or would like to contribute your point of view, please call either Nick Trim at Continuum on 0207 554 8686 or Mick Hayes, Chief Executive of Trust Thamesmead on 0208 320 4470.



your invitation

The Gallions Sales team invites you to view the last few remaining 1 and 2 bedroom apartments at Thames Walk, West Thamesmead, on Saturday 23rd July 10 am - 3pm.

These shared ownership apartments come with carpets throughout, a designer fitted kitchen with stainless steel oven and hob, ensuite bathrooms to most designs, state of the art audio-visual entry system and secure private parking. Priority for these homes will go to Gallions tenants. **If you earn £22,000*p.a. you could own one of these fabulous riverside apartments.**

Viewings will be held on an appointment basis, to book your place and for more information call Brenda Olwa today on Freephone 0800 731 4587 or email homes@gallionsha.co.uk.

This could be your last chance to own a stylish riverside home. Don't just take our word for it, come along and see for yourself!



GALLIONS HOUSING ASSOCIATION

* Represents a single annual income with no outstanding financial commitments. A joint income of £28,000 is required. This will buy a 45% share valued at £67,500 in a 1 bedroom apartment valued at £150,000. A subsidised rent is payable on the remainder. Only 2 bedroom apartments at Thames Walk have river views. Full market value of a 2 bedroom apartment is £210,000

www.gallionsha.co.uk



GALLIONS FREEPHONE 0800 83 84 81

YOUR COMMENTS COUNT

We are reviewing our resident involvement programme and need your help to make changes. If you have a group and would like us to come along and hear your point of view, just give us a call. Your comments can make a difference.

You told us **- that street lamping was poor in Thamesmead East.** After a walkabout with the police and surveyors we have relamped, repaired and upgraded the affected areas. Today, Hartslock Drive, the parking and walkways under Tavy Bridge and the pathway around Southmere are a lot brighter.

You told us **- that there wasn't enough for young people to do in Thamesmead.** We have teamed up with Charlton Athletic Football Club to run regular football coaching sessions over the school holidays. More than 100 youngsters have already taken part and it's back this summer.

You told us **- you wanted more police on Thamesmead's streets.** Working with the Police, we have established a dedicated police team based in Gallions offices. The team has grown to include 4 PCs,4 Police Community Support Officers and a dedicated Police Sergeant - all familiar faces on our streets.

CHILD CARER GROUP • COMMUNITY GROUP • YOUTH GROUP • SPORTS GROUP • RESIDENTS GROUP

Call Sue Pollard or Mike Robinson 0800 83 84 81

ਜੇ ਅੰਗਰੇਜ਼ੀ ਤੁਹਾਡੀ ਪਹਿਲੀ ਭਾਸ਼ਾ ਨਹੀਂ, ਅਤੇ ਤੁਸੀਂ ਇਸ ਦਸਤਾਵੇਜ਼ ਦਾ ਤਰਜਮਾ ਚਾਹੁੰਦੇ ਹੋ, ਤਾਂ ਕਿਰਪਾ ਕਰਕੇ ਆਪਣੀ ਚੁਣੀ ਹੋਈ ਭਾਸ਼ਾ ਦੇ ਨਾਂ ਦੇ ਨੇੜੇ ਢਾਲੇ ਖ਼ਾਨੇ ਵਿਚ ਸਹੀ ਦਾ ਨਿਸ਼ਾਨ ਲਾ ਕੇ, ਅਤੇ ਦੱਸੀ ਹੋਈ ਥਾਂ 'ਤੇ ਆਪਣਾ ਨਾਂ ਅਤੇ ਪਤਾ ਲਿਖ ਕੇ ਇਹ ਫਾਰਮ ਕਿਸੇ ਲਿਫ਼ਾਫ਼ੇ ਵਿਚ ਪਾ ਕੇ ਹੇਠ ਲਿਖੇ ਪਤੇ 'ਤੇ ਭੇਜ ਦਿਓ।

如果英語不是您的母語，您希望將該文件翻譯出來的話，請在您選擇的語言旁邊打勾，請在所示之處填上您的姓名和地址，併用信封將本表格寄到下列地址。

Nếu Anh ngữ không phải là ngôn ngữ chính, Quý vị muốn dịch tài liệu này, xin vui lòng đánh dấu vào ô kế bên ngôn ngữ Quý vị chọn, ghi tên và địa chỉ vào nơi chỉ dẫn và gởi mẫu vào phòng bì theo địa chỉ dưới đây.

July 05

PUNJABI ☐ **CHINESE** ☐ **VIETNAMESE** ☐

(please tick one)

Name: _____

Address: _____

Return to: Joy McKee, Translation Requests, Gallions Housing Association, Harrow Manor Way, London SE2 9XH

Contact us

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Harrow Manor Way
London
SE2 9XH

For all enquiries please contact the
Customer Response Centre
0800 83 84 81
It's a freephone number that you can use to book services, repairs or for any other enquiries.

GALLIONS HOUSING ASSOCIATION